Zine Bakery: exploring zines for DH research, methods training, and scholarly communication

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This poster familiarizes digital humanists with:

1. what zines are, and
2. what zines can make possible for the digital humanities

by introducing the *Zine Bakery* (ZineBakery.com) scholarly project .

Zines are a media form often pictured as their late 20th-century format of self-designed and -published, collaged, xerox replicated, and freely distributed paper booklets on topics including subcultures, leftist politics, and personal essays. Today, creators make "zines" that vary widely in format, including 100+ page tiny books and no-print-version creative websites. Through a zine typology visualization, analysis of zine bibliographic features and creator goals, and showcase of exemplar DH zines, this poster demonstrates zines are a welcoming, inexpensive, and effective format for do-it-yourself scholarly communication, friendly teaching of digital research methods, and public humanities outreach—as well as an opportunity for data analysis and other DH explorations.

The *Zine Bakery* project is a portal to a variety of such zine-inspired DH opportunities, including:

1. A public relational-database catalogue of zines with 375+ DHy zines and over 60 metadata fields per zine; over 40 of those zines are explicitly DH-focused, with another 110+ zines in immediately adjacent areas including feminist tech, coding tutorials, AI, and data science (not counting zines in other related areas such as libraries and archives, and social justice advocacy)
2. Info visualization of DHy zine covers and bibliographic metadata
3. Active research blog sharing the latest DH zine theory and practice, including the technical aspects of dataset-building, catalogue interface design, and info visualization
4. Digital preservation of precariously-online zine files

In addition to showcasing and explaining the above DH project methodologies, this poster offers:

1. Both digital and data-physicalization versions of the DHy zine database (an actual quilt with sewn features further visualizing and summarizing zine catalogue metadata)
2. QR code linking to a bibliography of free e-reading versions of DHy zines
3. Printed-paper, example DHy zines attendees can take away for free
4. A limited number of DH zines themed reading card decks, distributed to attendees who share DHy zines not yet in my catalogue with me

This poster will interest DH center, makerspace, and library staff managing public spaces and events where zines could be taught or shared; teachers of digital methods seeking new ways to support student learning; scholars and students new to DH who'd benefit from seeing a Posner "how did they make that?" level of friendly documentation around a current DH project; and DH researchers looking for ways to better share their work with the public.

The *Zine Bakery* research catalogue's focus is on zines at the intersections of tech, culture, and justice, meaning its hundreds of zines largely overlap with conference themes, including digital humanities; public, crowdsourced, and citizen humanities; social justice, equity, diversity, inclusion in academia and around digital methods and projects; archives and digital preservation; ethics of humanities AI; DH pedagogy; technical method teaching; humanities approaches to climate sustainability; and social justice advocacy.

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